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Question

Fiber Characteristics of Mouflon, Navajo-Churro, and Spanish Merino Sheep

Type of sheep	Diameter of outer coat fibers (in microns)	Diameter of inner coat fibers (in microns)
Spanish Merino	19–24	17–21
Navajo-Churro	35 or higher	10–35
Mouflon	150	15

Domestic sheep’s wild ancestor, the mouflon, has a coarse outer coat and an inner coat of wool fiber that is finer in diameter and therefore much softer. In some domestic breeds, such as the Spanish Merino, the outer fiber is only marginally coarser than the inner, and the wool is soft overall. Thus, Merino wool is ideal for delicate garments worn against the skin. Meanwhile, the Navajo-Churro has been selected to retain the marked distinction between outer and inner fiber that the Merino has lost. Being coarser than Merino wool overall, Navajo-Churro wool yields a more durable yarn, which Diné (Navajo) weavers use in their celebrated rugs. Yet a comparison of the fiber characteristics of all three sheep reveals that _____

Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the text?

Answer

- A. the selection process that enabled the Navajo-Churro to retain its somewhat coarse outer fiber also resulted in inner fiber that, at its softest, is softer than either the mouflon’s or the Merino’s inner fiber.
- B. the Navajo-Churro more closely resembles its ancestor, the mouflon, in the uniform softness of its inner fiber, while the Merino more closely resembles the mouflon in the variable diameter of its outer fiber.
- C. domestication resulted in a counterintuitive increase in the inner fiber’s minimum diameter, making the inner fiber of the Merino and the Navajo-Churro less suitable for delicate garments than the mouflon’s inner fiber is.
- D. the domestication of the mouflon and the subsequent selection process that produced the Merino and the Navajo-Churro resulted in greater softness of outer and inner fiber alike.